are significant differences, including the mode of travel. Given the oncoming Lok Sabha elections, this yatra is oriented towards election outcomes. This is more reason why the Bharat Jodo Yatra needs to be carefully documented and studied for its wider and continuing impact.

In Rajasthan, of the five assurances made during the Yatra, only the social accountability legislation remained unfulfilled. But as the BJY passed through Punjab, Rahul Gandhi called to put us in touch with the newly elected Himachal Pradesh chief minister, asking us to meet him and discuss the social accountability law and the gig workers' law. This kind of proactive effort can only come when an idea or a set of ideas have an opportunity to take root in a political ecosystem.

Finally, there is perhaps the most important lesson for all leaders—that Rahul Gandhi tried to unsuccessfully pass on to many Congress leaders, at least in Rajasthan. In Dausa and Alwar he strongly suggested that the state Congress leadership begin padyatras every month. He told them that walking would not only keep them healthy, but it would also keep democracy and their relationship with people healthy. He said beginning at the top—from the state cabinet—everyone should get out of their cars and security cordons and walk. He said that like him, they would learn a lot, get confident about connecting with people and be of real service to people—the padyatras would ensure this. In Rajasthan, the Congress leadership was full of praise and admiration for the padyatra, but nobody followed Rahul's advice. Had they done so, democratic decision-making and implementation would certainly have improved dramatically. And perhaps even the electoral result in Rajasthan would have been different.

As the next big yatra began, where other modes of travel are being used, the potential of the BJY padyatra giving birth to many other consultative padyatras should be given serious consideration. Not just the party political class, but even civil society and social activists would greatly benefit from the democratic culture that every such padyatra would build. Eventually, it is the people who will benefit the most—and that will be the most lasting legacy of the Bharat Jodo Yatra.